

Insta360 X6

The 360-degree camera that edits for you

Vyom Ramani | editor@digit.in

The Insta360 X6 landed on my desk almost immediately after launch, and I had it out of the box before I'd even read the spec sheet. I'd spent years scrolling past mini planet shots and gravity-defying follow-cams online, always from the outside looking in, and this was the first time one of these cameras was in my hand. So I did the obvious thing: went straight out into the mumbai rain, hopped in a local, and generally treated a review unit like a toy I'd waited too long to unwrap. Round two came a few days later on a bike ride through the hills near a dam outside Pune. A few hundred clips and one editing app later, I have a read on what this camera does.

Design and handling

It is notably smaller and even slightly lighter compared to its predecessor. In terms of design, Insta360 has included a pressure-sensitive touch feature, which allows to press any place on the screen for starting or stopping recording, which has become the reason for making it compact. If you are used to pressing a button rather than the screen, then you will find the record button right under the power button on the right side.

Moreover, battery life was increased to 2,600 mAh (compared to 2,400 mAh), which provides up to 140 minutes of recording at 8K30 format in the Endurance mode. X6 also comes with the 64 GB internal storage (usable 47 GB) along with the microSD card, which means that not having a memory card at hand will no longer be a problem. It should be noted that lenses are replaceable just like on the X5, which can become quite important when one lens gets scratched accidentally. I did not have the invisible selfie stick provided by Insta360, but my old tripod served its purpose well. This is one of the benefits of the camera – it does not require a lot of equipment.

One problem that showed up was how rapidly it heats up. It can get really hot really quickly that if you are using it handheld, you will feel the heat and it will be uncomfortable. However, it isn't exactly a camera that is meant to be handheld, you will always have it attached to a selfie stick or a mount so that should not be too big of an issue.

Video Quality and Modes

The bigger sensors are the headline upgrade here, and they show up most obviously in the 120-megapixel 360 stills, which is a big jump for a camera this size. Video tops out at 8K50, with the option to drop to 6K or 4K, the latter hitting 100fps in standard 360 mode. Colour-wise, you get regular SDR, Dolby Vision, and a 10-bit I-Log profile, so if you're the sort who wants full grading control, the I-Log is there for you.

With the camera turned into Flat mode, the X6 functions as a wide-angle point-and-shoot, recording 16:9, 1:1 or 9:16 videos and taking photos using the same ratio. It does limit the performance a bit (5K60 video and 24MP stills due to the fact that you use only half the camera), but it is still noticeably larger than the sensors found in phones. Finally, the InstaFrame 2.0 feature follows the subject in the picture and creates an automatically edited 16:9 or 9:16 video while retaining the full 360 version just in case.

How 360 degree gets edited

Post processing 360 content has always been the most annoying thing about